

Behaviour Policy

Growing in Christ. Thriving in Learning. Shaping the Future.

Version	3.0 — replaces the 2025/26 policy	Applies to Reception to Year 11
Approved by	LCET Trustees, 1 st October 2026	Reviewed by Andy Harris, Headteacher
Next review	September 2027	Statutory basis ISSR Part 3, paragraph 9

WHAT HAS CHANGED IN THIS VERSION

This policy is rebuilt on the vision and values the school settled in August 2026. It replaces the eleven-word values list with the **six CHRIST values**, sets behaviour inside the **seven Emmanuel Fundamentals and their habits**, and points to **Speaking Truth in Love** for the conversations themselves. It also corrects the legal basis: Emmanuel is an independent school, so the statutory exclusion framework for maintained schools does not apply to us and our position on removal is contractual. Guidance references are updated, the prohibition on corporal punishment is now stated, and the restraint section is rewritten on current law.

1. Why we have this policy

Every child at Emmanuel is made in the image of God. That is not a sentiment we add to a behaviour policy; it is the reason we have one. A child who is made in God's image is owed order, safety and the expectation that they can do better — and is owed them consistently, whether they are easy to teach that week or not.

So our discipline is discipleship. We are not managing a building; we are forming people. That means high expectations and real consequences, and it equally means forgiveness, a fresh start, and an adult who does not give up. Both, always.

This policy tells you what we expect, what happens when it does not happen, and what you can rely on from us. It applies to every pupil from Reception to Year 11, to every member of staff, and to volunteers and visitors working with our pupils.

2. The CHRIST values

Behaviour at Emmanuel is measured against six values. They are the same six the curriculum, the Teaching and Learning Framework and our lesson observations use, so a pupil hears one language across the school.

Value	What it looks like in behaviour
Christ-Centred	We start from who Christ is and what He is like. Pupils are asked to consider not only what the rule is, but what love requires.
Hope-Filled	Nobody is written off. Every day starts again, and a pupil's worst week is not their name.
Relationally-Built	Behaviour is repaired between people, not only recorded against them. Relationship comes before sanction and survives it.
Integrity-Driven	We tell the truth about what happened — pupils and adults alike — and we do the right thing when nobody is checking.
Servant-Hearted	We consider the person our behaviour lands on. Disruption is not a private matter; it takes something from someone else.

Value	What it looks like in behaviour
Truth-Rooted	We name things accurately. Kindness that will not tell the truth is not kindness, and truth without grace is not ours.

The Emmanuel Fundamentals

The Fundamentals are our seven culture commitments, and each one carries a habit that proves it. **The Fundamentals are how we love; Christ in All Things is how we teach** — and behaviour is where the Fundamentals are most visible. A laminated list changes nothing: the habits are the fundamentals. This policy sits underneath them rather than beside them, and where the two are read together, the habit is the test.

“We love because he first loved us.” — 1 John 4:19

	The fundamental	The habit that proves it
1	Love the children first, because Christ loved us first. <i>Make it obvious.</i>	A leader on the gate every morning. Every child greeted by name before nine o'clock.
2	Every child bears God's image. <i>Act like it — especially with the hardest child on the hardest day.</i>	We name behaviour, never children. After every incident, the first thing offered is a fresh start — and staff pray for pupils by name each week.
3	Relationships are two-way. <i>The more you give and value people, the more they give back.</i>	Every family hears something good about their child before they ever hear something hard. Two good-news messages home, per teacher, per week.
4	Reach out to Leicester and make all the moves. <i>Some will say no. Keep going.</i>	One visible act of service in the community every term. Every enquiry answered within a school day; a tour is always possible.
5	Be brilliant at safeguarding. <i>Go over and above — love that doesn't protect isn't love.</i>	Logged the same day, every time. If in doubt, tell the DSL — no concern is too small. Safeguarding is the first item in every staff meeting.
6	The door stays open. <i>Leavers come back; families in hard seasons are held, not chased.</i>	Former pupils are welcomed back by name, and invited back each September. A family in difficulty gets a conversation before it ever gets a letter.
7	Grace, not softness. <i>High expectations held with warmth — because that is how God deals with us.</i>	Every consequence ends with the way back, said out loud. Correction is finished only when restoration has started.

FUNDAMENTALS 2 AND 7 ARE THE LOAD-BEARING ONES FOR BEHAVIOUR

We name behaviour, never children — “that was a dangerous thing to do”, never “you are a nuisance”. And **every consequence ends with the way back, said out loud** — the pupil leaves the conversation knowing what they must do and that it will be enough. A sanction that does not name the way back has not finished.

Speaking Truth in Love

This policy sets the framework. **Speaking Truth in Love** is the companion document and sets out how the conversations are actually held, including the agreed escalation. Staff should read the two together; where this policy says a conversation happens, Speaking Truth in Love says how.

3. What we expect

Of pupils

- Arrive on time, in correct uniform, ready to learn
- Listen to adults and follow instructions first time
- Work hard without taking learning from anybody else

- Move calmly and safely around the school
- Treat every person with kindness and respect
- Take care of property — the school's and other people's
- Hand in mobile phones on arrival (see §9)
- Tell the truth and own what you did

Of staff

- Model the CHRIST values in words, tone and manner — particularly when correcting
- Apply this policy consistently, so that pupils experience the same school in every room
- Keep language calm, clear and respectful; never sarcastic, never shaming
- **Name the behaviour, never the child** — describe what was done, not what the pupil is
- Offer the fresh start out loud after every incident, and say the way back as part of every consequence
- Notice and name good behaviour far more often than poor behaviour
- Record what the policy requires, promptly and factually
- Repair the relationship afterwards — the sanction is not the end of it

Of parents and carers

- Support the school's expectations and Christian ethos at home
- Talk about school positively in front of your child, and bring concerns to us directly
- Tell us about anything at home that may affect your child's behaviour
- Come in when we ask, and work with us on a plan
- Celebrate what goes well — most of it does

4. Recognition and reward

We recognise good behaviour far more than we sanction poor behaviour, because that is what forms a culture. **Our aim is to build one another up** (1 Thessalonians 5:11).

Verbal praise	Immediate, specific and public where it will not embarrass. The most-used reward in the school and the one that matters most.
House points	Awarded for effort, kindness and achievement. Every pupil belongs to one of four houses — Bradgate, Brocks, Bosworth and Beacon — and points are totalled towards the House Cup.
Special mentions	At Friday celebration assembly, from any member of staff, for anything worth saying in front of the whole school. The pupil takes a postcard home; the ticket goes into the termly draw.
Certificates and stickers	Used routinely in Lower School and wherever they still carry weight.
Contact home	A note, postcard, email or phone call for something good. Two good-news messages home, per teacher, per week — the habit under Fundamental 3. Every family hears something good about their child before they ever hear something hard.
Annual awards	The House Cup at the summer celebration, the Sports Day trophy, and the Headteacher's Award for a pupil who has consistently shown Christ-like attitudes to learning and to people.

5. Consequences

Consequences are certain, proportionate and calm. What deters is knowing something will happen — not how severe it is. Staff should not raise their voice to raise the stakes.

Stage	Lower School	Middle and Upper School
1	Reminder — a calm, private prompt naming the expectation	Reminder — the same
2	Warning — named, recorded, and a clear chance to put it right	Warning — the same
3	Loss of part of playtime, with reflection	Detention or behaviour point
4	Meeting with class teacher or Head of Lower School, parents informed	Referral to SLT and contact home
5	Referral to SLT	Internal isolation
6	—	Suspension or removal — Headteacher only (see §7)

Serious behaviour goes straight to a senior leader, skipping the stages: violence, bullying, discrimination, sexual harassment or violence, prohibited items, anything unsafe.

Resets, and why they matter

The ladder resets at the end of each lesson or session, and **every day starts clean**. That is not softness; it is the Hope-Filled value doing its job, and it is why a pupil will still try on a Thursday. Under Fundamental 2, **after every incident the first thing offered is a fresh start** — offered by the adult, out loud, not left for the pupil to infer. Stage 3 and above are recorded even though the ladder resets, so that patterns are seen even when individual days are forgiven.

Behaviour is recorded on **Go4Schools**. **Safeguarding concerns are never recorded there; they go in CPOMS only**. If a behaviour incident turns out to have a safeguarding dimension, the behaviour record stays on Go4Schools and a separate concern is logged on CPOMS the same day.

Repair

Every Stage 3 and above ends with a restorative conversation, usually of two or three minutes. Four questions:

- What happened?
- Who was affected, and how?
- What will you do to put it right?
- What will you do differently next time?

The conversation ends with **the way back, said out loud** — what the pupil does next, and the adult's word that it will be enough. **A sanction served without repair has taught a pupil to take punishment, not to change**, and under Fundamental 7 correction is finished only when restoration has started. Speaking Truth in Love sets out how to hold these conversations well.

6. Lateness, equipment and uniform

These are not disruption, but they still need handling the same way in every room. In each case: a reminder first, a warning second, a Stage 3 consequence on the third occasion in a half term, and SLT involvement with a support plan if it persists.

Lateness	Many of our families travel a distance, so common sense applies to a one-off with a genuine reason. Repeated lateness is a pattern and is treated as one.
PE kit and equipment	Spare kit is used where we have it. Persistent forgetting is met with a plan — often kit kept in school — not an escalating series of detentions.
Uniform	Corrected on the spot where possible. Where cost is the reason, we help discreetly and we do not sanction . No child is punished for what a family cannot afford.

Homework	Homework is currently under review through the homework-free pilot. Until that review concludes, non-completion is followed up with the pupil and, where it persists, with parents — but it is not treated as misbehaviour and carries no sanction. [ECS TO CONFIRM: update this row when the pilot decision is taken.]
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7. Serious behaviour, suspension and removal

Emmanuel is an independent school. The statutory exclusion framework for maintained schools, academies and pupil referral units does not apply to us. Our authority to suspend or require the removal of a pupil comes from the parent contract, and is exercised by the Headteacher alone.

Suspension	A fixed period away from school, imposed by the Headteacher for serious or persistent behaviour. Parents are informed in writing the same day, with the reason and the return arrangements. Work is provided.
Required removal	Permanent, and a last resort. Reserved for behaviour that makes it unsafe or untenable for the pupil to remain, or for a persistent pattern that every support has failed to shift.
Review	Parents may ask the Trustees to review a decision to require removal. [ECS TO CONFIRM: confirm the review route and timescale, and that it matches the parent contract.]

Before either step, the Headteacher will consider the pupil's SEND, any safeguarding history, and whether the school has genuinely done what it said it would. **Where behaviour is a communication of need rather than a choice, removal is rarely the answer and never the first one.**

Fundamental 6 governs how this is done as much as whether: **a family in difficulty gets a conversation before it ever gets a letter.** Nothing at this level reaches a parent in writing that has not first been said to them face to face or on the phone, unless a safeguarding reason prevents it. The door stays open afterwards.

Corporal punishment

Corporal punishment is prohibited at Emmanuel Christian School and is unlawful. It may not be used or threatened by any member of staff, volunteer or other adult, at any time, including on trips and in any setting where a pupil is in our care. This applies to everyone, without exception.

8. Where behaviour is a safeguarding matter

Bullying, discrimination, sexual harassment, sexual violence and abuse between children are **safeguarding matters first and behaviour matters second.** They are reported to the DSL and handled under the Child Protection and Safeguarding Policy. A sanction may follow; it never replaces the safeguarding response.

Our DSL is **Andy Harris**, Headteacher. The Deputy DSL is **Sarah Seeds**. Fundamental 5 sets the standard: **logged the same day, every time. If in doubt, tell the DSL — no concern is too small.** A behaviour record is never a substitute for a safeguarding report.

We take a **zero-tolerance approach to sexual harassment and sexual violence:** never dismissed, never treated as banter, never left for the pupils to sort out. Pupils are told repeatedly that reporting something small is always welcome.

Where behaviour may be criminal, the Headteacher decides whether to report it to the police, preserves any evidence, and does not obstruct their enquiries. The school may still run its own process alongside.

9. Specific situations

Mobile phones	Phones are handed in at the main reception desk on arrival and collected from there at the end of the day. A phone not handed in is confiscated and held at reception until the end of the day; a repeat is a Stage 3 consequence and contact home. See the Mobile Phone Policy.
Off-site behaviour	We may sanction behaviour outside school where the pupil is representing the school, travelling to or from it, in uniform or otherwise identifiable as one of ours — and where behaviour anywhere threatens another pupil or the orderly running of the school.
Online behaviour	Treated the same way. Online conduct that harms another pupil or affects the school is within scope, whenever and wherever it happened.
Searching and confiscation	Carried out in line with the DfE's guidance on searching, screening and confiscation. Searches are conducted by staff authorised by the Headteacher, normally of the same sex as the pupil and with a witness. Strip searches are for police only. Every search for a prohibited item, including those finding nothing, is recorded and reported to the DSL, and parents are always told.
Damage to property	Parents may be asked to meet the cost of wilful damage or loss, at the Headteacher's discretion. Unpaid charges may affect participation in optional activities such as trips. Examination certificates are never withheld — JCQ General Regulations for Approved Centres 5.14(b) requires a centre to distribute certificates to all candidates without delay and regardless of any dispute, including non-payment.
Malicious allegations	Where an allegation against staff or another pupil is shown to be deliberately invented, we consider a sanction — and we also consider whether the allegation was a cry for help needing a safeguarding response.

10. Reasonable force

All staff have a legal power to use reasonable force, under **section 93 of the Education and Inspections Act 2006**, and only to prevent a pupil from hurting themselves or others, damaging property, or committing an offence, or to maintain good order and discipline.

THE FOUR RULES THAT NEVER CHANGE

Force is a last resort, used only when the risk of not acting outweighs the risk of acting. **It is the minimum needed, for the shortest time. It is never a punishment** — using force to punish is always unlawful. **It is always recorded and always reported to parents the same day.**

Before using force, staff use every other strategy available: calm language, space, time, a change of adult. Where a pupil's SEND, medical condition or history makes force more likely to be needed, the SENDCo will ensure an individual risk assessment and plan are in place, and staff working with that pupil will be trained.

Staff should not touch a pupil in a way that could be read as sexually inappropriate, and should avoid acting alone where another adult can be summoned safely.

After an incident	
Record	The staff member records the incident the same day — what led to it, what was done, how long, who was present, any injury.
Report	To the Headteacher and the relevant Head of School.
Inform parents	The same day, by the Headteacher or a Head of School.
Review	The Headteacher reviews every use of force and considers whether the plan around that pupil needs to change.

11. Pupils with SEND

Behaviour is often communication. Before treating a pattern as defiance, staff consider whether the pupil can actually do what is being asked, in the form it is being asked.

- Reasonable adjustments are made — extra time, visual prompts, movement breaks, a reduced instruction load
- The SENDCo, **Libby Harris**, is involved in planning strategies for any pupil where behaviour is a recurring concern
- Adjustments are recorded in the pupil's plan so that every adult applies the same ones
- External advice is sought where the school's own strategies are not working
- **Sanctions are adjusted, not removed** — a pupil with SEND is still owed boundaries

12. Monitoring

Senior leaders review behaviour records each half term, looking at patterns by pupil, by class, by time of day and by type. **We look specifically for whether any group of pupils is being sanctioned disproportionately** — by SEND status, by year group, by anything else the data shows.

Behaviour is reported to the Trustees termly. This policy is reviewed annually by the Headteacher and SLT, and approved by the Trustees, using that data together with the views of pupils, staff and parents.

At each September INSET we ask one question of every Fundamental — **is the habit still true?** Where it is not, we fix the habit before we reword the value, and this policy is amended to match. The behaviour-facing habits are checked with evidence, not by show of hands: the good-news messages home, the fresh start offered after incidents, and the way back named in consequences.

13. Related documents

- Speaking Truth in Love — how the conversations are held
- The Emmanuel Fundamentals — the culture this policy serves (reproduced at \$2)
- Child Protection and Safeguarding Policy
- Anti-Bullying Policy
- Mobile Phone Policy
- SEND Policy
- Health and Safety Policy
- The parent contract, which carries our authority to suspend and to require removal

14. Legal basis

Schedule 1 of the Education (Independent School Standards) Regulations 2014 — paragraph 7 (safeguarding), paragraph 9 (a written behaviour policy, implemented effectively) and paragraph 10 (an anti-bullying strategy).

Section 548 of the Education Act 1996 — prohibition of corporal punishment. **Section 93 of the Education and Inspections Act 2006** — use of reasonable force. **The Equality Act 2010**.

DfE guidance: Behaviour in schools (updated February 2024); Searching, screening and confiscation; Use of reasonable force; Keeping Children Safe in Education 2026; Supporting pupils with medical conditions at school; the SEND Code of Practice.

STATEMENT OF BEHAVIOUR PRINCIPLES

Every pupil has the right to feel safe, valued and respected, and to learn without disruption from others. Pupils, staff and visitors are free from discrimination. Adults set the example. Rewards, consequences and reasonable force are applied consistently. Pupils are helped to take responsibility rather than merely to accept punishment. Families are involved. Removal is a last resort, and behaviour that is a communication of need is answered with support before sanction.

Violence and threatening behaviour are not tolerated from anyone, towards anyone.

